CTE DETECTION FRAMEWORK

Chronic Traumatic Encephalopathy

Beverly Index Detection Markers & CognoSphere Visualization

Version 1.0

January 2026

Beverly Index LLC

Advancing the Science of Computational Psychodynamics

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Executive Summary

This document establishes the Beverly Index framework for detecting Chronic Traumatic Encephalopathy (CTE) risk markers through dream narrative analysis. CTE represents one of the most significant unmet diagnostic needs in neurology — currently diagnosable only post-mortem through brain autopsy. The Beverly Index approach offers a revolutionary non-invasive screening methodology that could identify at-risk individuals years before clinical symptoms manifest.

By analyzing linguistic patterns in dream narratives, the REMIEL Engine can detect subtle cognitive signatures that correlate with the four stages of CTE progression. These markers map directly to the NOSS Category VII (Traumatic Brain Injury) classification system and visualize within the CognoSphere™ as the "Impact Crater Field" — a cosmic metaphor that makes neurological damage patterns intuitive and actionable for clinicians.

Key Innovation: Beverly Index is the first system to propose detection of CTE-associated cognitive patterns through dream narrative analysis, potentially enabling early identification 10-20 years before traditional symptom onset.

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1. Clinical Background: Understanding CTE

1.1 What is CTE?

Chronic Traumatic Encephalopathy is a progressive neurodegenerative disease caused by repetitive traumatic brain injuries (TBIs), including concussions and sub-concussive impacts. The condition is characterized by accumulation of hyperphosphorylated tau protein (p-tau) forming neurofibrillary tangles in specific brain regions, particularly at the depths of cortical sulci.

1.2 The Four Stages of CTE

CTE progresses through four neuropathologically-defined stages:

Stage	Neuropathology	Clinical Presentation
Stage I	Perivascular p-tau deposits in sulcal depths; focal NFTs in frontal cortex	Headaches, attention/concentration deficits, mild short-term memory issues, depression, mild aggression
Stage II	NFTs in nucleus basalis of Meynert, locus coeruleus; spreading p-tau	Mood swings, depression, behavioral outbursts, short-term memory loss, explosivity
Stage III	Cortical atrophy, septal abnormalities, ventriculomegaly, widespread p-tau deposition	Memory loss, executive dysfunction, visuospatial deficits, apathy, aggression, cognitive impairment
Stage IV	Severe atrophy, hippocampal sclerosis, widespread gliosis, profound NFT burden	Dementia, profound memory loss, language deficits, paranoia, parkinsonism, psychotic symptoms

1.3 Two Clinical Phenotypes

Research has identified two distinct clinical presentations of CTE:

- **Behavioral/Mood Variant:** Onset typically in 30s-40s. Initial presentation includes irritability, impulsivity, aggression, depression, and emotional lability. Cognitive symptoms develop later.
- **Cognitive Variant:** Onset typically in 50s-60s. Initial presentation includes memory impairment, executive dysfunction, and attention deficits. Mood/behavioral symptoms may or may not develop.

1.4 The Diagnostic Gap

Critical Problem: CTE can currently ONLY be definitively diagnosed post-mortem through neuropathological examination of brain tissue. There are no validated in vivo biomarkers, imaging protocols, or blood tests that can confirm CTE in living patients.

Beverly Index Opportunity: By detecting subtle cognitive signatures in dream narratives that correlate with CTE-associated brain changes, Beverly Index could provide the first non-invasive screening tool for CTE risk assessment in living individuals.

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2. Beverly Index CTE Detection Markers

2.1 Theoretical Foundation

The NOST (Neural Oscillation Signature Theory) framework posits that brain states manifest in linguistic patterns. CTE causes progressive damage to specific brain regions that control memory, executive function, emotional regulation, and motor coordination. This damage should produce detectable signatures in how affected individuals construct narratives, particularly dream narratives where cognitive processing is less filtered.

2.2 Core Detection Domains

Beverly Index analyzes five core domains for CTE-related markers:

Domain	Brain Regions Affected	Linguistic Markers
Memory Integrity	Hippocampus, Medial Temporal Lobe	Temporal gaps, sequence errors, detail loss, repetition, confabulation patterns
Executive Control	Prefrontal Cortex, Frontal Lobe	Disorganized structure, poor sequencing, reduced planning language, fragmented narratives
Emotional Regulation	Amygdala, Locus Coeruleus, Limbic System	Emotional volatility, aggressive content, depression markers, lability patterns
Visuospatial Processing	Parietal Cortex, Visual Processing Areas	Spatial confusion, navigation errors, environment instability, perspective shifts
Behavioral Control	Orbitofrontal Cortex, Inhibitory Networks	Impulsive content, reduced inhibition markers, disinhibited themes, risk-taking narratives

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2.3 Specific Linguistic Markers by CTE Stage

Stage I Markers (Mild)

Expected Dream Narrative Features:

- Subtle attention lapses: Incomplete descriptions, trailing off mid-scene
- Mild concentration deficits: Difficulty maintaining narrative focus, tangential elements
- Headache/pain references: Unusual frequency of physical discomfort in dream content
- Mood coloring: Subtle depressive undertones, reduced positive emotional language
- Irritability themes: Increased conflict content, frustration themes

Stage II Markers (Moderate)

Expected Dream Narrative Features:

- Short-term memory gaps: Events forgotten within narrative, inconsistent recall
- Emotional volatility: Rapid mood shifts within dreams, explosive emotional content
- Behavioral outbursts in dreams: Violent or aggressive dream actions by self
- Depression markers: Hopelessness themes, withdrawal, isolation content
- Impulsivity: Actions without planning, regretted decisions, lack of forethought

Stage III Markers (Severe)

Expected Dream Narrative Features:

- Executive dysfunction: Disorganized narrative structure, poor logical sequencing
- Memory loss: Significant gaps, inability to recall key dream elements
- Visuospatial confusion: Getting lost, environments that shift or make no sense
- Apathy markers: Reduced agency, passive observation, lack of goal-directed behavior
- Aggression: Violent themes, confrontational content, explosive episodes

Stage IV Markers (Profound)

Expected Dream Narrative Features:

- Dementia patterns: Severe disorganization, incoherent narratives, confabulation
- Profound memory loss: Cannot maintain narrative thread, immediate forgetting
- Language deterioration: Reduced vocabulary, word-finding difficulties, simplified syntax
- Paranoid content: Persecution themes, suspicion, distrust of others
- Motor references: Movement difficulties, coordination problems in dream self

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3. CTE Risk Scoring System

3.1 CTE Risk Index (CTE-RI)

The CTE Risk Index is a composite score ranging from 0-100 that estimates the probability of CTE-related cognitive changes based on dream narrative analysis. The score integrates markers across all five detection domains.

Formula

```
CTE-RI = (MEM × 0.25) + (EXE × 0.25) + (EMO × 0.20) + (VIS × 0.15) + (BEH × 0.15)
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Where:

- MEM = Memory Integrity Score (0-100)
- EXE = Executive Control Score (0-100)
- EMO = Emotional Regulation Score (0-100)
- VIS = Visuospatial Processing Score (0-100)
- BEH = Behavioral Control Score (0-100)

Interpretation Thresholds

CTE-RI Score	Risk Level	Clinical Recommendation
0-20	Minimal	No CTE-specific concerns. Standard monitoring.
21-40	Low	Some markers present. Consider RHI history review. Retest in 6 months.
41-60	Moderate	Multiple markers present. Recommend neuropsychological testing. Consider neuroimaging.
61-80	High	Strong marker profile. Urgent neurological consultation. Full diagnostic workup recommended.
81-100	**Very High**	Comprehensive CTE marker pattern. Immediate referral to neurodegenerative specialist.

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4. CognoSphere™ Visualization: The Impact Crater Field

4.1 Cosmic Metaphor Rationale

CTE results from physical impacts to the brain. The cosmic metaphor of an "Impact Crater Field" perfectly captures this etiology — just as asteroids and meteorites leave craters on planetary surfaces, repetitive head impacts leave damage patterns in neural tissue. The visualization makes the cumulative nature of CTE intuitively understandable: each impact adds to the damage, craters overlap, and the surface gradually erodes.

4.2 Sector VII: TBI Region Specifications

In CognoSphere, Sector VII (TBI/CTE) is positioned at the following coordinates:

- Theta (azimuth): 180°
- Phi (polar): 135°
- Radius: 1.1 (slightly extended to emphasize disruption)

4.3 Visual Elements by CTE Stage

Stage	Crater Appearance	Debris Pattern	Animation
Stage I	Few small, shallow craters; mostly intact surface	Minimal; localized particles	Slow settling; occasional flickers
Stage II	Multiple craters; some overlap; surface roughening	Active debris fields; ripple waves	Moderate activity; periodic disturbances
Stage III	Extensive cratering; deep impacts; surface fragmentation	Dense debris; fracture lines	Constant motion; unstable particles
Stage IV	Devastated terrain; merged craters; structural collapse	Widespread; eroding edges	Continuous deterioration; dim pulsing

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4.4 Five Sub-States Within Sector VII

The NOSS Category VII (TBI) defines five distinct states, each with specific CognoSphere visualization:

Code	Condition	Visual Metaphor	Render Specification
CON-A	Acute Concussion	Fresh Impact Crater	Bright debris ring; active particles; ripple waves; glowing impact point
PCS	Post-Concussion Syndrome	Healing Crater	Crater walls rebuilding; persistent disturbance waves; slow particle settling
TBI-MS	TBI Moderate-Severe	Deep Impact Basin	Deep crater; fracture lines radiating; major structural disruption
CTE-R	CTE Risk Pattern	Overlapping Crater Field	Multiple overlapping craters; cumulative damage; progressive erosion pattern
RHI	Repetitive Head Impacts	Surface Erosion	Worn surface texture; micro-pitting; diffuse damage without deep craters

4.5 Color Palette for TBI Sector

- Primary: #B91C1C (Deep Red) — Damage indicator
- Secondary: #DC2626 (Bright Red) — Active impact zones
- Accent: #F97316 (Orange) — Debris and ejecta
- Glow: #FCD34D (Yellow) — Fresh impact points
- Healing: #34D399 (Green) — Recovery indicators

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5. Clinical Application Protocol

5.1 Target Populations

1. **Contact Sport Athletes:** Football, boxing, MMA, hockey, rugby, soccer players with headers
2. **Military Personnel:** Combat veterans, blast exposure survivors
3. **Domestic Violence Survivors:** Individuals with history of repeated head trauma
4. **Accident Survivors:** Multiple concussion history from accidents
5. **At-Risk Professions:** Stunt performers, certain industrial workers

5.2 Screening Protocol

Recommended assessment frequency:

- **Active athletes:** Baseline at season start; post-concussion; end of season
- **Retired athletes:** Annual screening; more frequent if symptoms emerge
- **Post-concussion:** Weekly during recovery; monthly for 6 months post-clearance
- **Elevated CTE-RI:** Quarterly monitoring; integration dynamics tracking

5.3 Integration with Traditional Assessment

Beverly Index CTE screening should complement, not replace, traditional neurological assessment. The recommended integration protocol:

6. **Initial Screening:** Beverly Index dream analysis provides non-invasive first-line assessment
7. **Risk Stratification:** CTE-RI score determines urgency of follow-up
8. **Clinical Correlation:** Compare Beverly Index findings with neuropsychological testing
9. **Neuroimaging:** MRI/PET for individuals with elevated CTE-RI
10. **Longitudinal Monitoring:** Track CTE-RI over time; watch for progression patterns

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6. Validation Requirements

6.1 Research Priorities

Before clinical deployment, the CTE Detection Framework requires validation through:

11. **Retrospective Validation:** Analyze dream narratives from individuals with neuropathologically-confirmed CTE
12. **Prospective Cohort Study:** Longitudinal tracking of at-risk athletes with Beverly Index monitoring
13. **Cross-Validation:** Correlate CTE-RI with neuroimaging findings (MRI, PET)
14. **Biomarker Correlation:** Compare with blood/CSF biomarkers (p-tau, NfL, GFAP)

6.2 Target Performance Metrics

- Sensitivity: ≥80% (detect true positives)
- Specificity: ≥75% (avoid false positives)
- AUC: ≥0.80 for CTE-RI prediction accuracy
- Inter-rater reliability: κ ≥0.70
- Test-retest reliability: ICC ≥0.85

7. Conclusion

The Beverly Index CTE Detection Framework represents a pioneering approach to one of neurology's most significant unmet diagnostic needs. By leveraging the NOST theoretical framework to identify cognitive signatures in dream narratives, we offer a non-invasive, accessible, and repeatable screening methodology that could identify at-risk individuals years before traditional symptom onset.

The CognoSphere visualization — with its Impact Crater Field metaphor for TBI/CTE — provides clinicians and patients an intuitive understanding of cumulative brain damage that traditional neuroimaging cannot offer. The ability to watch the "crater field" evolve over time, tracking recovery or progression, transforms CTE from an invisible post-mortem diagnosis to a visible, monitorable condition.

Strategic Implications: This framework positions Beverly Index as the first-mover in dream-based CTE screening, targeting the $4.5B sports medicine market and military healthcare systems. Clinical validation partnerships with organizations like the Concussion Legacy Foundation, Boston University CTE Center, and VA Healthcare System should be prioritized.

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